

Bwana awabariki (May God grant you a blessing)

Text: Swahili; Kenyan traditional; tr. anonymous

Music: Kenyan traditional

BWANA AWABARIKI irregular

The musical score is written for guitar and voice. It consists of two systems of music. The first system has four measures, and the second system has six measures. Each measure is accompanied by a guitar chord diagram and a vocal line. The chords are: Gb (1 3 4 2 1 1), Ebm (x x 3 2 4 1), Cb (x x x 3 1 2 1), Db (x x 3 1 2 1), Gb (1 3 4 2 1 1), Ebm (x x 3 2 4 1), Cb (x x x 3 1 2 1), Gb/Db (x x x vi 2 3 1 4), Db7 (x x 2 3 1 4), and Gb (1 3 4 2 1 1). The vocal line is in 4/4 time and features a melody that is repeated in the first system and then continues in the second system. The lyrics are in Swahili and English, and the music is in a key with four flats (Bb, Eb, Ab, Db).

Gb Ebm Cb Db

Bwa - na a - wa - ba - ri - ki, Bwa - na a - wa - ba - ri - ki,
May God grant you a bless - ing, may God grant you a bless - ing,

Gb Ebm Cb Gb/Db Db7 Gb

Bwa - na a - wa - ba - ri - ki, mi - le - le
may God grant you a bless - ing, ev - er - more.